



Refresher Course - It Hertz!

gaming on an 8K TV. The only reason why you should be making an exception for buying an 8K TV for gaming is if you have an expensive monster gaming PC lying around that you plan to hook up to your new TV. And even then know that you're going to be very limited in finding titles that'll support this resolution.

What about movies and TV shows you ask? The problem remains the same. While there is content available in 8K, albeit in very limited in quantity. OTT platforms for obvious reasons currently do not host your favourite 8K content on their servers so you're honestly better off saving yourself some money and not invest in an 8K TV right now.

Analyse dimming tech

If you're buying an LED TV it is very important to ensure that you don't make a buying decision the moment you see local dimming printed on the box. As an evolving technology on TVs, we currently get a couple of different versions of it at the moment. However, more often than not, this information is hidden from the buyer.

But a little bit of research can give you access to this information. As a rule of thumb, prefer TVs with full array

or backlit local dimming (the most common on LED TVs these days) and then LED TVs that offer edge-lit dimming. While there isn't much to be concerned about with full array dimming, in the case of back-lit dimming, you'll have

to dig for more information and find out how many dimming zones are offered by the TV. This number can be anywhere between 4-12 and as a rule of thumb, the higher is better. So do your research and choose wisely.

FYI

- **Refresh Rate:** The refresh rate of your display is indicative of how many times (per second) your display itself refreshes. For example, if your display has a refresh rate of 144Hz, it is refreshing the contents of the display 144 times every second.
- **Frame Rate:** The frame rate of your video is indicative of how many images of the video are displayed consecutively, over the span of one second. While traditional film footage has a slower frame rate of 23.976 (rounded off to 24) frames in a second, HFR videos tend to veer towards 40-120 frames in a second.

Motion rate is a scam

The next trap to not fall for when you're buying a new TV is the one of Motion Rate. If you've not realised it already, then let us break the news to you: Motion Rate is not the same as Frame Rate, which in turn, is very different from Refresh Rate.

So if you see a new TV being advertised with keywords such as TruMotion or Motion Flow, then here's a small 'refresher'. All these terms mean that your television will post-process videos being played to simulate HFR (high frame rate) videos. This, in no way means that it changes your screen's refresh rate, or the actual frame rate of the video being played.

Motion rate technologies are manufacturer-specific and depending on the technology in question, they either employ frame-rate interpolation or black-frame insertion to make movement in your video smoother. **[i]**